

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

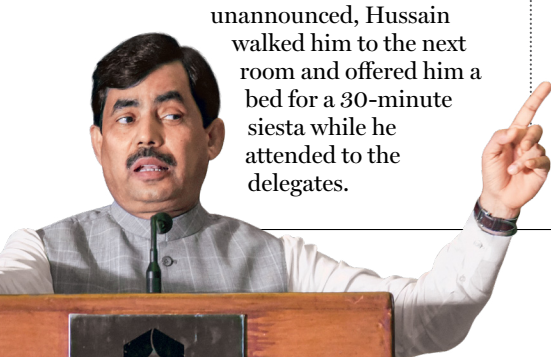
GLASSHOUSE

PERFORM OR PERISH

Names missing from the BJP's latest list of 18 nominees for the forthcoming Rajya Sabha polls have raised many eyebrows. Prominent among those who missed out are Union minority affairs minister **Mukhtar Abbas Naqvi**, former Union ministers Prakash Javadekar and Shiv Pratap Shukla, and veterans O.P. Mathur and Vinay Sahasrabuddhe. Arch-rival of Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath on his home turf Gorakhpur, Shukla had to make way for Yogi's protege Radha Mohan Das Agarwal. Spokesperson Syed Zafar Islam and general secretary Dushyant Gautam were kept out due to underperformance. Sanjay Seth, a turncoat from the Samajwadi Party, was dropped for not doing enough for the BJP during the assembly poll. All is not lost for Naqvi, though. He may get a ticket for the Lok Sabha bypoll from Rampur.

Sweet Surprise

A delegation of businessmen was pleasantly surprised with the hospitality they received at the residence of Bihar's industry minister **Shahnawaz Hussain**. Besides serving them special *motichoor laddoo*, the minister told a businessman from Kerala that Bihar—'God's *karmabhoomi*'—is a natural choice for those from 'God's own country'. When a former BJP minister arrived unannounced, Hussain walked him to the next room and offered him a bed for a 30-minute siesta while he attended to the delegates.





HOT IN THE HILLS

West Bengal chief minister **Mamata Banerjee** is on another 'working break', her second in two weeks. The choice of destination—Maoist-hit Jangalmahal—is unusual given the scorching heat. The hills in Bengal's north have been her favourite, especially in summer, but the political temperature there is soaring with party ally and GJM (Gorkha Janmukti Morcha) leader Bimal Gurung on a hunger strike against the government's decision to hold Gorkhaland Territorial Administration polls on June 26. Besides, her bête noire Governor Jagdeep Dhankhar is in Darjeeling, recuperating from malaria.



STARRING THE CM

Chhattisgarh chief minister **Bhupesh Baghel** made his Hindi film debut recently, playing himself. While touring Balod district for his Bhent Mulaqat outreach programme, he was told that a film on the Nishaad community was being shot, not far from where he was to attend his official engagement. The makers requested him to play CM Baghel in the film based on how the community's living standards have improved through fishing. The shot had the CM cast a net in the water and he managed to get it right in one take.



Prime Goal

With Dasara being an auspicious time for new beginnings, Telangana Rashtra Samithi chief and state chief minister **K. Chandrasekhar Rao** is set to use the occasion on October 5 as a springboard for his foray into national politics. He is expected to hand over the governance of Telangana to his son and TRS working president K.T. Rama Rao. The generational change is likely to extend to the selection of candidates for the 2023 assembly poll. Young blood for a young state.

–Kaushik Deka with Anilesh S. Mahajan, Romita Datta, Amitabh Srivastava, Rahul Noronha and Amarnath K. Menon